

A LEADERSHIP BRIEFING FOR CEOS & FOUNDERS

A Leader's Guide to 100x Impact



Kill BUSYness

Build High Performance Organizations

MANOJ ONKAR

*"Your organisation is full of hardworking, committed people.
Everyone is busy.
Yet the results aren't what they should be."*

REFLECT · OWN · ASSERT · RUN

MANOJ ONKAR · FOUNDER, MANAGEMENT INNOVATIONS

THE CORE INSIGHT

Your calendar is full. Is your organisation actually moving?

Every CEO has felt this contradiction: teams working at full capacity, meetings back to back, inboxes never empty — and results that still lag the effort. Manoj Onkar names this condition **BUSYness**: motion mistaken for progress, activity mistaken for advantage.

Drawn from 25 years of consulting with CEOs and leadership teams across India, Thailand, the Philippines and beyond, *Kill BUSYness* makes the case that BUSYness is not a time-management failure or a people problem. **It is a leadership outcome** — created at the top, normalised in the middle, and absorbed at the bottom.

“BUSYness isn’t a time management problem. It isn’t a people problem. It is a leadership problem.”

THE QUESTION THIS BOOK ASKS

If you approach this book as a mirror rather than a checklist, the question it puts to you isn’t really about your organisation. It is about you — and the standards you are willing to hold, starting with yourself.

60–70%

OF ORGANISATIONAL TIME, IN THE BOOK’S CLIENT RESEARCH, GOES TO CHASING WORK ALREADY COMMITTED TO — NOT CREATING VALUE

8–12 hrs

SPENT EVERY WEEK BY SENIOR LEADERS CHASING UPDATES ON COMMITMENTS ALREADY MADE

That is the promise of this book: a CEO’s companion for the deliberate work of building an organisation that runs on clarity and ownership, not on chasing and reminders — a genuine partner for building a High-Performance Organisation.

WHY NOW

The pattern repeats across industries and geographies: hardworking teams, rising costs of coordination, and a widening gap between the organisation a CEO intends to build and the one that shows up every Monday morning. *Kill BUSYness* was written to close that gap — starting with the leader, not the org chart.

The ROAR Model — a leader's pathway from motion to meaning

At the centre of the book is a single disciplined pathway, distilled from more than two decades of closing the gap between the organisation leaders intend to build and the one they actually have. It begins with the leader — first — and moves outward.



ROAR reframes performance as an architecture — built into how the organisation reflects, owns, decides and acts — rather than something extracted through more effort from already-stretched people.

A DIFFERENT OPERATING PHILOSOPHY

The book draws a sharp line between two ways of leading people: **Extractive Management**, which treats people as a resource to be used, and **Regenerative Management**, which treats people as the source of the organisation's future. The shift from one to the other, the book argues through real leadership cases, is not just the more human choice. It is the more commercially sound one.

Over his decade leading Unilever, Paul Polman delivered nearly 300% in shareholder returns, outperforming competitors and the broader market — while shifting the company from extraction to co-creation with its people. The book's case: that shift wasn't just ethical. It was the most commercially sound decision he made.

Extractive Management

People treated as a resource to be used. Effort is squeezed for output. The relationship ends where the job description ends.

Regenerative Management

People treated as the source of the organisation's future. The leader creates conditions for people to co-create beyond their current capability.

WHAT'S INSIDE

A ten-chapter journey, built to be worked through — not just read

Each chapter closes with reflection exercises and a Mirror Question, designed for a leader and their leadership team to work through together, not just consume.

R • REFLECT

- 01 **The BUSYness Mirror** — naming the cycle of Uncertainty → Overactivity → BUSYness, and the BUSYness Index that measures it.
- 02 **Purpose** — why a felt, working purpose is what makes decisions faster and retains your best people.
- 03 **Strategy** — how BUSYness hides the absence of real strategic choice, and the discipline of saying no.
- 04 **The Competency Chain** — how capability gaps quietly compromise training, sales, delivery and brand.

O • OWN

- 05 **Reflection** — the four levels of listening, and what becomes visible once the noise stops.
- 06 **Ownership** — the BUSY culture vs. the High-Performance culture, and the standard of No Follow-Up Required.

A • ASSERT

- 07 **Leadership Creates** — the shift from ego-centric to eco-centric leadership.
- 08 **Assert the Standard** — the Four Non-Negotiables every CEO puts in place personally.

R • RUN

- 09 **Build** — a twelve-phase implementation plan that turns the model into an operating rhythm.
- 10 **Sustaining Greatness** — keeping High Performance a practice, long after the initial push fades.

WHAT BUSYNESS SILENCES, FIRST

Chapter 1 opens with this: long before performance stalls, three quieter withdrawals happen, in this order.

1 • Silence of the Head

Ideas stop being shared. Innovation is never attempted.

2 • Silence of the Heart

Creativity withdraws. Courage goes absent.

3 • Silence of the Soul

Purpose goes quiet, meaning evaporates. BUSYness is not the cause — it is what rushes in to fill the void left by these three successive withdrawals.

Four Non-Negotiables that change how the whole organisation runs

The book argues these belong to the CEO personally — not delegated, not outsourced.

1. No Follow-Up Required

Commitments are owned, not chased. A reminder culture is an accountability tax.

2. World-Class in Every Function

Not “good for our size” — the standard the world’s best organisations have already proven possible.

3. Break the Silo

“There are no successful departments in a failed organisation.” One team, or nothing.

4. People as Source, Not Resource

A generative relationship with people, where the leader creates conditions for people to co-create beyond their current capability.

WHY IT MATTERS — THE EVIDENCE BASE

The book grounds its argument in research from Gallup, Deloitte, Porter Novelli and others, cited throughout with a full bibliography. Three figures the book highlights:

11%

GREATER PROFITABILITY FOR ORGANISATIONS THAT INVEST SIGNIFICANTLY IN PEOPLE DEVELOPMENT (DELOITTE, 2023)

2×

MORE LIKELY TO REACH THE TOP QUARTILE OF FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE (DELOITTE, 2023)

78%

MORE LIKELY TO WANT TO WORK FOR AN ORGANISATION THAT LEADS WITH PURPOSE (PORTER NOVELLI, 2021)

FROM INSIGHT TO OPERATING RHYTHM

Chapter 9 turns the ROAR Model into a **twelve-phase implementation blueprint** — the same sequence the author uses inside client organisations, covering everything from freeing leadership calendars for deep work, to a structured sensing journey with the people closest to the customer, to embedding the standards so they survive a change in leadership.

01 Free the Calendar — every leader verifiably reclaims time for deep work, protected from BUSYness.

02 The Sensing Journey — deep connection with customers and frontline teams, before any redesign begins.

03 Assert the Standards — the Four Non-Negotiables installed, starting with the leader’s own behaviour.

04 Build to Last — the rhythm embedded so it survives a change in leadership, not just a change in mood.

WHAT CEOS ARE ALREADY SAYING

Endorsed by the leaders who live this every day

“Every serious CEO needs to read this book, not once, but at every stage of their leadership journey.”

Nand Kishore Chaudhary · Founder, Jaipur Rugs

“Manoj’s diagnosis stopped me cold: an organisation that runs on follow-up runs on surveillance, not trust.”

Utpal Vaishnav · Founder, EightQor Group

“It is strategic, inventive, and purposeful — a book that can genuinely shift how organisations think about performance, governance, and long-term impact.”

Manjula Pooja Shroff · Founder Chairperson, MD & CEO, Kalorex Group

“I have learned, practised and propagated the tools of Six Sigma, Lean, Strategy and AI over 30 years. Yet I find this book more fundamental — it raises primal questions, and then answers them in a way which wakes and shakes a conscious leader.”

Chetan Khosla · Chairman, Suryojasvi Group of Companies

ABOUT THE AUTHOR



Manoj Onkar is the Founder of Management Innovations, an organisation-development ecosystem built around one mission: reinventing management and helping leaders build extraordinary organisations. Over 25 years, he and his team have trained more than 100,000 people across 30+ industries in India, Thailand, the Philippines and beyond.

He has delivered leadership programmes for senior government leadership, including the then Chief Minister of Gujarat and his team of ministers and IAS officers, and has worked with public institutions including the Lokayukta of Karnataka. His approach draws on Theory U (Dr. Otto Scharmer, MIT), the Balanced Scorecard, and Exponential Organisation principles.

CLIENTS INCLUDE — Reliance Group · Tata Steel · TCS · Accenture · Zydus Group · Kirlskar · ONGC · Kotak Foundation · GMDC · PayNearby

“Every serious CEO needs to read this book, not once, but at every stage of their leadership journey” is not a line written for effect. It reflects how the leaders above are already using *Kill BUSYness* — as a working companion, revisited at each stage of building a High-Performance Organisation.

FOR CEOS READY TO LEAD DIFFERENTLY

Not another book of ideas. A working partner for the build.

"The leaders in these pages didn't find a better time-management system. They found a better way to lead — and when that happened, everything changed."

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